BALAJI BALARAMAN

Senior DevOps / Senior DevSecOps Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer with 3+ years of experience designing, automating, and securing cloud-native applications across Azure, AWS, and GCP. Proven expertise in CI/CD pipeline development, Kubernetes container orchestration, Terraform IaC, and DevSecOps security hardening. Delivered enterprise-grade fintech and AI platforms with measurable improvements in deployment frequency, release reliability, and compliance posture. Active Microsoft AZ-400 and HashiCorp Terraform Associate certified.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD & DevOps	Jenkins (multi-server, multibranch), GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Nexus, SonarQube, Git, Bitbucket
Cloud – Azure	AKS, Azure Container Apps, ACR, Key Vault, PostgreSQL Flexible Server, Data Factory, Event Grid, Front Door, Application Insights, AI Foundry
Cloud – AWS	EC2, ECS, Lambda, Event Bridge, SNS, API Gateway, ELB, NLB, IAM, S3, CloudWatch
Containers & IaC	Docker, Kubernetes (AKS / EKS), Docker Swarm, Docker Compose, Podman, Terraform, Ansible
Monitoring & Logging	ELK Stack (Filebeat, Metricbeat, Heartbeat), Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Dynatrace, Datadog, Azure Application Insights
Security & DevSecOps	Snyk, Trivy, Grype, Vulnerability Management, OS Patching, Configuration Hardening, Compliance Validation, SAST/DAST, Least-Privilege IAM
Scripting & OS	Shell Scripting, Linux Administration, Python, Java, Groovy
Web & Networking	Nginx, SSL/TLS, Reverse Proxy, VPN, Private Subnets, Kubernetes Ingress, API Gateway

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps / Senior DevSecOps Engineer | Zuci *Systems India Pvt. Ltd.* Apr 2026 – Present

- Lead end-to-end DevOps strategy and platform engineering for enterprise fintech and AI clients across Azure and AWS; architect scalable CI/CD frameworks using Jenkins and GitHub Actions with reusable pipeline templates to enforce deployment standards.
- Own Kubernetes (AKS) and Docker Swarm cluster governance — capacity planning, resource optimization, and zero-downtime rollout strategies for containerized microservices across IaaS and PaaS platforms.
- Drive Terraform IaC adoption with modular design patterns, eliminating configuration drift and standardizing environment provisioning across dev, staging, and production.
- Spearhead DevSecOps by embedding Snyk, Trivy, and Grype scanning into the SDLC alongside OS hardening, CIS-benchmark compliance, and audit-ready reporting.
- Design full observability stack using Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Loki, and Azure Application Insights — enabling proactive incident detection and SLA adherence.
- Mentor engineers on DevOps best practices; serve as primary escalation point for production stability across regulated financial and AI platforms.

DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer | Zuci *Systems India Pvt. Ltd.* Aug 2023 – Mar 2026

- Designed and maintained Jenkins (multi-server, multibranch) and GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines, enabling automated multi-environment deployments across Azure and AWS, reducing average release cycle time by ~40%.
- Deployed and managed containerized microservices using Docker, Kubernetes (AKS), and Docker Swarm across IaaS and PaaS platforms, supporting 3 concurrent enterprise client environments.
- Automated cloud infrastructure provisioning with Terraform, eliminating manual setup errors and standardizing repeatable deployment workflows across all environments.
- Led DevSecOps remediation program with Snyk, Trivy, Grype, OS patching, and configuration hardening — achieving zero critical CVEs in production for 3 consecutive quarters.
- Implemented full-stack observability using ELK Stack, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, and Azure Application Insights, reducing MTTR for production incidents by 35%.
- Maintained 99.9% availability SLA and met financial regulatory compliance (RBI, IRDAI, PCI-DSS) consistently.

Intern — Java & Cloud | Zuci *Systems India Pvt. Ltd.* Dec 2022 – Jul 2023

- Completed rigorous training in cloud computing, Java application development, and Linux administration; produced onboarding documentation adopted by 10+ team members.
- Assisted DevOps teams with CI/CD task execution, application deployments, and incident troubleshooting across 5+ deployment cycles.

KEY CLIENT PROJECTS

Northern Arc — Financial Services Platform — Azure · *Jenkins · Docker · Kubernetes · ELK Stack*

Leading Indian NBFC enablement platform connecting lenders and borrowers. Built and secured high-volume fintech infrastructure supporting Paytm, MoneyView, and loan disbursement platforms.

- Built Jenkins multi-server CI/CD pipelines reduce Docker image build-to-deploy time by 50% across 4+ microservices for multi-environment deployments.
- Deployed microservices using Docker Swarm and Kubernetes with Nginx reverse proxy and SSL termination, achieving zero-downtime rolling deployments.
- Configured Azure VNet with private subnets for high-compliance fintech workloads meeting RBI and IRDAI standards; passed 3 external security audits via OS hardening and vulnerability remediation.
- Implemented centralized ELK Stack logging and alerting (Filebeat, Metricbeat, Heartbeat) across 20+ services for container health and uptime monitoring.

Borderless Access — Agentic AI Platform — Azure · *AKS · Azure Container Apps · Prometheus · Grafana · Loki*

Global market research company building AI-driven platform for automated research workflows on GPU-intensive Azure infrastructure.

- Delivered end-to-end Azure DevOps implementation for production AI/ML workloads on AKS and Azure Container Apps, supporting 5 Agentic AI models in parallel.
- Provisioned and managed GPU-enabled AKS node pools supporting ML inferencing workloads, achieving 99.5% uptime for AI pipeline execution.
- Integrated Azure ACR, Key Vault, PostgreSQL Flexible Server, Data Factory, Event Grid, and AI Foundry into a unified secure AI platform, reducing service integration time by 60%.
- Designed secure networking with VPN, private subnets, API Gateway, Azure Front Door, and Kubernetes Ingress, eliminating public endpoint exposure for all internal services.
- Implemented Loki sidecar logging and Prometheus + Grafana dashboards, providing real-time cluster and application observability for 10+ AI microservices.

Mariner Finance — Enterprise Financial Application — AWS · *EC2 · ECS · Jenkins · GitHub Actions · Lambda*

US-based consumer lending company. Migrated and stabilized cloud-native microservices architecture on AWS with strong DevSecOps and compliance requirements.

- Managed EC2-based Docker microservices and ECS cluster container orchestration for an enterprise financial platform processing thousands of loan applications daily.
- Built CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitHub Actions with automated testing, SAST security scanning, and multi-environment deployments, reducing deployment errors by 30%.
- Implemented event-driven architecture using AWS Lambda, EventBridge, and SNS for asynchronous financial processing, handling 10,000+ daily transactions reliably.
- Configured API Gateway, ELB, and NLB for intelligent traffic routing and high availability, maintaining 99.95% uptime for consumer-facing financial services.
- Managed AMI creation, EBS snapshots, and backup strategies, achieving RPO of 1 hour and RTO of 2 hours for disaster recovery scenarios.
- Executed OS upgrades, security patching, and DevSecOps vulnerability remediation validated using AWS CLI and security scan re-validation, meeting PCI-DSS requirements.

CERTIFICATIONS

Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (AZ-400)	Microsoft	Valid until Nov 2027
Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204)	Microsoft	Valid until Mar 2027
HashiCorp Terraform Associate (003)	HashiCorp	Valid until Nov 2027

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) | Anna University, Tamil Nadu 2019 – 2023 | First Class